

OUTSIDE CANADA · STUDY PERMIT APPLICATION

Document *Checklist*

Updated June 2026

Regular Stream (Post-SDS)

futurelinkconsultants.com

Verify at canada.ca

⚠ SDS & NSE streams officially closed Nov 8, 2024. All applicants now apply through the Regular Study Permit Stream only. Master's / PhD at public DLIs are exempt from the PAL/TAL requirement as of Jan 1, 2026.

CLIENT NAME	FILE ID	COUNTRY OF RESIDENCE
Full name as on passport	FLC-2026-XXXX	e.g. India, Philippines...
PROGRAM LEVEL	DLI TYPE	SUBMISSION DATE
Select level... ▼	Select... ▼	yyyy-mm-dd

COMPLETION

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IDENTITY & TRAVEL DOCUMENTS

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Valid passport — bio data page + any previously issued Canadian visa pages

REQUIRED

Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond intended stay; upload colour scan.

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Digital photo — IRCC specifications (420 × 540 px, white background, neutral expression)

REQUIRED

File must be a recent photo, ≤ 4 MB, JPEG format. Check IRCC photo tool at canada.ca.

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IRCC online profile complete — IMM 5257 / online application signed & reviewed

REQUIRED

All questions answered, no blanks; use "NA" where applicable. Review for consistency with supporting documents.

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Family information form IMM 5707 (or IMM 5645 if applicable)

IF APPLICABLE

Required for all family members. IMM 5645 used for clients with common-law partner or children.

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LETTER OF ACCEPTANCE, DLI & PAL/TAL

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Original Letter of Acceptance (LOA) — must show full program name, start/end dates, and tuition amount

LOA must be from a Designated Learning Institution (DLI). Conditional acceptance requires conditions to be met before travel.

REQUIRED

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DLI number verified against IRCC's official DLI list at [canada.ca](#)

DLI status can change; confirm the institution remains active at time of submission.

REQUIRED

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Program start date allows realistic IRCC processing time (check current estimates at [canada.ca](#))

Current processing times vary by visa office. Plan for 8–16 weeks. Defer intake if needed.

REQUIRED

PROVINCIAL / TERRITORIAL ATTESTATION LETTER (PAL/TAL) — 2026 RULES

☐

PAL/TAL from province/territory of study (undergraduate, PG diploma, certificate applicants)

Required for all undergraduate and PG diploma/certificate students at any DLI. Obtain from your institution — they hold the quota from their province. For Quebec, the CAQ attestation from MIFI acts as the PAL/TAL.

2024 RULE

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PAL/TAL exemption confirmed (Master's or PhD at a public DLI, K–12, study permit extension at same DLI)

As of Jan 1 2026, master's and doctoral students at public DLIs are PAL-exempt. Include a note in the application confirming this exemption category. Extensions at same DLI & same level are also exempt.

EXEMPT (2026)

C FINANCIAL PROOF

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MINIMUM FUNDS (AS OF SEP 1, 2025)

- ☐ **Proof of living funds: at least CAD \$22,895 (for one person) in addition to first-year tuition + travel costs** **UPDATED 2025**
Updated threshold effective Sept 1 2025 (up from \$20,635). Must be shown in addition to tuition. Add ~\$4,000/dependent if bringing family.
- ☐ **Bank statements — minimum 4–6 months showing consistent balance, transactions & account holder name** **REQUIRED**
All statements must be officially certified/stamped by the bank. Sudden large deposits raise red flags and require explanation letters.
- ☐ **GIC (Guaranteed Investment Certificate) from a participating Canadian financial institution — verify current required amount** **RECOMMENDED**
GIC is still accepted as proof of funds. Confirm the current required GIC amount with the institution at time of purchase (amounts change). Acceptable banks include RBC, TD, Scotiabank, CIBC, BMO, etc.
- ☐ **Proof of first-year tuition payment (or proof of tuition fee payment arrangement with institution)** **REQUIRED**
For multi-year programs, first year's tuition must be proven paid or secured. Receipt from institution or bank transfer record required.

IF SPONSORED BY THIRD PARTY

- ☐ **Sponsor's letter of financial support — signed, notarized, detailing relationship and committed amount** **IF SPONSORED**
Include explanation of the relationship to applicant.
- ☐ **Sponsor's supporting documents — government-issued ID, income tax returns (2–3 years), salary slips, employment letter** **IF SPONSORED**
All documents must be translated into English or French by a certified translator if in another language.

D LANGUAGE & ACADEMIC DOCUMENTS

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- ☐ **Language test result (TRF) — IELTS Academic / CELPIP / PTE Academic / TEF Canada / DALF as required by your institution** **IF REQUIRED BY DLI**
IRCC does not set a language score for the study permit itself, but your institution does. Confirm required test & score with institution. Note: IELTS / TEF are also now required for PGWP at post-graduation stage.
- ☐ **Academic transcripts — all levels completed (secondary, post-secondary if applicable), official sealed copies** **REQUIRED**
Must include mark sheets and certificates. If not in English or French, include certified translations.
- ☐ **Degrees / diplomas — original and copies; certified English/French translations where applicable** **REQUIRED**
Credential evaluations (e.g. WES) may also be required by the institution, not IRCC.
- ☐ **Statement of Purpose (SOP) / Study Plan — demonstrates genuine student intent, clear academic & career pathway** **REQUIRED**
Address: why Canada, why this school/program, how it connects to past studies and future plans, intent to return home after studies. Must be original, not a template.

E PGWP ELIGIBILITY CHECK (POST-GRADUATION WORK PERMIT)

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- ☐ **Confirm program is PGWP-eligible — verify on IRCC's list at canada.ca (1,107+ eligible programs as of June 2025)** **UPDATED 2025**
Bachelor's, Master's, and PhD remain fully eligible regardless of field. Private colleges licensing public curriculum are NOT PGWP-eligible. 178 programs pending removal — confirm status before applying.
- ☐ **Confirm institution type for PGWP — must be a public DLI (private DLIs licensing public curriculum do not qualify)** **REQUIRED CHECK**
Clarified in 2025. If client intends to work post-graduation, DLI type must be confirmed before enrollment decision.
- ☐ **Spouse/partner open work permit eligibility noted — OWP now limited to spouses of Master's and PhD students only** **2024 RULE**
As of 2024. Spouses of undergraduate or diploma students are no longer eligible for OWP. Advise client accordingly.

F MEDICAL, BIOMETRICS & POLICE CERTIFICATES

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- ☐ **Upfront medical examination — completed by IRCC-designated panel physician where required by country of residence / study duration** **IF REQUIRED**
 Required if studying 6+ months AND from or residing 6+ months in a designated country. Check IRCC's country list at canada.ca. Results go directly to IRCC from the physician.
- ☐ **Biometrics — booked within 30 days of Biometric Instruction Letter (BIL) being issued by IRCC** **REQUIRED**
 Biometrics must be given at an authorized location in your country. If previously given and still valid (10-year validity), confirm on IRCC account — may be exempt. Fees: CAD \$85 per person, \$170 family max.
- ☐ **Police certificate(s) — from each country where client has lived 6+ months since age 18** **PER VISA OFFICE**
 Check which visa office requires upfront police certificate vs. on request. Requirements vary by visa office. Certificates must be less than 3 months old at submission.

G FEES & SUBMISSION

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- ☐ **Study permit application fee paid — CAD \$150 per person; receipt/confirmation saved** **REQUIRED**
 Pay via IRCC secure payment portal. Save the official payment receipt with transaction ID.
- ☐ **Biometrics fee paid — CAD \$85 (individual) or \$170 (family, max); receipt saved** **REQUIRED**
 If biometrics already on file and valid, confirm exemption in IRCC account before paying.
- ☐ **Client has reviewed, signed, and dated this checklist confirming all documents collected** **REQUIRED**
- ☐ **Quality review / QA sign-off completed by counselor — all documents cross-checked against IRCC requirements** **REQUIRED**
 Counselor must verify: no documents expired, all translations certified, all forms complete, consistency across all supporting documents.
- ☐ **Application submitted via client's IRCC online account; submission confirmation (application number) saved on file** **REQUIRED**
 Screenshot and save the IRCC confirmation page. Note the UCI (Unique Client Identifier) and application number for tracking.

CLIENT SIGNATURE & DATE

COUNSELOR / QA SIGN-OFF & DATE

Sign here...

Sign here...

Future Link Consultants — Internal Working Document · Not an official IRCC form
Always verify requirements at **canada.ca** before submission · v2.0 Jun 2026

www.futurelinkconsultants.com
Regulated Canadian Immigration Consulting